

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- Sheffield's finance committee approved extra funding for a new SEND facility at Stocksbridge Junior School — total budget now £823,000.
→ **For your school:** *Worth logging alongside Monday's exclusions discussion.*
- NAHT is calling for graded Ofsted inspections to be halted, warning the framework poses 'a real and present danger' to leader wellbeing.
- Schools Week disputes DfE's claim the 2026-27 teacher pay award is 'fully funded'; NEU's executive responds on 24 September.
- A quieter day otherwise — nothing else new broke overnight across DfE, SEND or national funding beyond what's already on your radar.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

24 Sep 2026 — NEU's national executive decides its formal response to the 2026-27 pay award, after Schools Week challenged DfE's 'fully funded' claim.

3 Oct 2026 — NEU opens a formal strike ballot over teacher pay and school funding, covering 280,000+ teachers; closes 15 Dec.

■ SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

▪ **Sheffield approves extra £758k for new SEND facility at Stocksbridge Junior School.** The finance and performance policy committee backed additional funding on Monday, taking the total to £823,000, for a Key Stage 2 Integrated Resource Provision for pupils with communication and interaction needs — citing rising local demand and families travelling long distances. Due to complete by May 2027; figures as reported ahead of published committee papers. ([The Star](#))

→ **For your school:** *A local capacity signal worth logging alongside Monday's exclusions discussion.*

■ OFSTED & ACCOUNTABILITY

▪ **NAHT calls for graded Ofsted inspections to be halted, citing risk to leader wellbeing.** A survey of 5,000+ school leaders found nearly three-quarters feel inspection has worsened over the past year, one year on from the report-card reforms. General secretary Paul Whiteman said the framework poses 'a real and present danger' to leaders' wellbeing; the union wants grades replaced with a short narrative report pending a review. ([ITV News](#))

→ **For your school:** *Worth watching how this lands with leaders you support — inspection stress can ripple into inclusion decisions.*

■ NATIONAL FUNDING

▪ **Is the 'fully funded' teacher pay rise actually new money? Schools Week says no.** DfE says the 3.5% pay award is fully funded via ~£500m/year in pension savings, but Schools Week argues schools already budgeted for those lower rates from April — so there's no genuine new money, and the saving varies school to school. ([Schools Week](#))

→ **For your school:** Useful if finance leads ask why 'fully funded' doesn't match their budget reality.

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

£823,000

Total budget approved by Sheffield's finance and performance policy committee for a new SEND Integrated Resource Provision at Stocksbridge Junior School, due to open by May 2027.

Sheffield City Council, via *The Star*, Sept 2026

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.